

Adult Learners

Dilan Karaguler

Why explore adult learning?

- My previous school's commitment to lifelong learning
- Need for higher education especially intelligence workers



Pedagogy vs Andragogy

- Pedagogy: “the art and science of teaching children” (derived from the Greek words paid, meaning “child,” and agogus, meaning “leader of”)
 - Andragogy: “the art and science of teaching adults” (andr- means adult)
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Discussion Questions (10 mins)

- Think about a time when you learned something new as an adult—what motivated you?
- What are the unique characteristics of adult learners?
- Can we group some of these responses into themes and categories?

5 Assumptions of adult learners or Characteristic of adult learners

Knowles' 5 Assumptions of Adult Learners

- **Self-concept:** As adults, we tend to prefer taking charge of our own learning.
 - **Use of Life Experience:** We bring our rich life experiences into learning situations.
 - **Readiness to learn:** We are more likely to learn things that relate to our current life roles.
 - **Orientation to Learning/Learning Focus:(Problem Centered)** We focus more on problem-solving and practical application.
 - **Motivation:** Our motivation comes from internal factors, like personal growth or achievement.
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Understanding Barriers to Adult Learning

Discussion Questions: (10 mins)

- What do you think might prevent an adult learner from succeeding in their learning journey?
 - Have you experienced or observed any challenges that adult learners face in educational settings?
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Understanding Barriers to Adult Learning

- **Time constraints** due to work, family, or other commitments.
 - **Motivation and confidence issues:** Lack of belief in one's ability to succeed.
 - **Financial constraints:** Tuition, books, or technology costs.
 - **Technological challenges:** Difficulty navigating new tools or online learning platforms.
 - **Physical or cognitive barriers:** Health issues, aging, or difficulty processing new information.
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Physical or cognitive barriers:

Crystallized vs Fluid Intelligence

Crystallized: “an individual’s learning from experience”

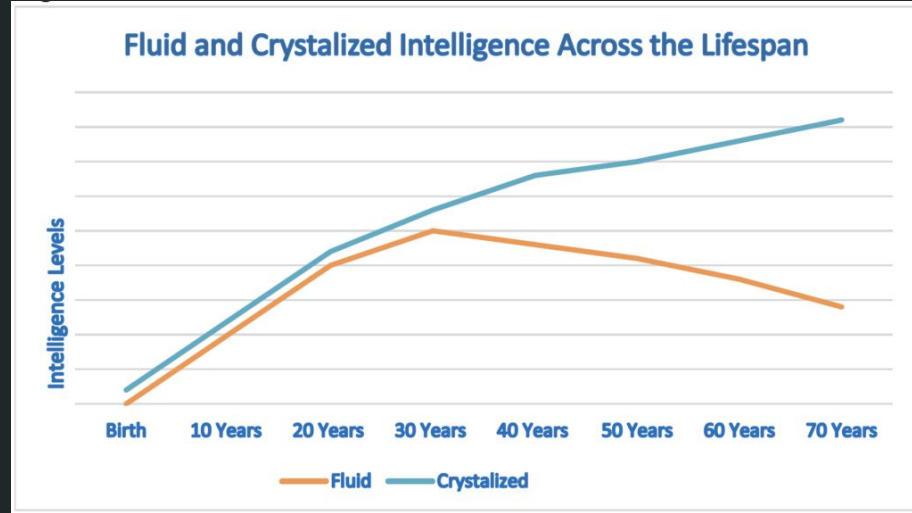
Fluid: “individual’s ability to see relationships without previous practice or knowledge”

Adult Learning Basics: William Rothwell

How this changes affects adult learners?

Younger adults tend to do best with problem solving and trying out new experiences, while older adults do best by building on their experience.

Adult Learning Basics: William Rothwell



LifeSpan Development: Chapter 8 Middle Adulthood

Adult Learning Strategies and Methods

- Based on barriers we discussed, what teaching strategies and methods do you think works better for adult learners?
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Resources

- **Knowles, M. S.** (2015). *The Adult Learner: The definitive classic in adult education and human resource development* (8th ed.). Routledge.
- **Rothwell, W. J.** (2010). *Adult Learning Basics*. ASTD Press.
- [Teaching Across Generations – Part I](#). (2014, July 9). University of Minnesota Teaching and Learning Initiative.
- [Lumen Learning – LifeSpan Development, Chapter 8: Middle Adulthood](#). (n.d.).